from: **VCA4D Value Chain** <vca4d@agrinatura-eu.eu>

to: VCA4D Value Chain <vca4d@agrinatura-eu.eu>

cc: Giorgia Mei <giorgia.mei@agrinatura-eu.eu>,
"Sahara ." <sahara@apps.ipb.ac.id>

date: Oct 15, 2026, 10:15 PM

subject: SAVE THE DATE! Analysis of Natural Rubber and Coconuts Value chain_ kick-off meeting to launch the studies! **20/10/2026_ 11.00am**

Dear Sir/Madame

Agrinatura, on behalf of the EU Delegation to Indonesia and the Ministry of National Planning/National Planning Development Agency (Bappenas) is delighted to invite you to the ***kick-off meeting to launch the VCA4D studies on natural rubber and coconuts in Indonesia***. The event will be held on ***20/10/2026***, at 11.00 am, in a hybrid form, at the EU Delegation and online (*see connection details in the save the date*).

The EU Delegation and Bappenas requested the VCA4D studies in order to have an evidence-based and robust diagnosis that can inform policy dialogue and project development for the promotion of a more inclusive and sustainable value chain in the coconuts and rubber sectors.
The two studies will be conducted using the EU value chain analysis toolkit, as described in the *"VCA4D Methodological Brief for agri-based value chain analysis*" (attached).
The findings of these studies will appraise and analyse the inclusiveness and sustainability of the rubber and coconut value chains from the economic, social and environmental point of view, highlighting the most important issues that require policy action, along with the significant risks, constraints and opportunities in the value chain development.

The ***kick-off meeting*** will provide an opportunity to meet the two teams of experts (three from Agrinatura and three nationals) who will conduct the study, and to discuss the objectives of the two analyses and the key issues to be investigated during the studies.

We kindly ask you to confirm your attendance at the kick-off meeting by replying to sahara@apps.ipb.ac.id (team leader of the coconut study), with CC vca4d@agrinatura-eu.eu

These studies are conducted in the framework of the VCA4D project which is funded by the EU and implemented by Agrinatura, the alliance of European universities and research centres specialized in agricultural research for development in EU's partner countries.

We look forward to having the confirmation of your attendance!

We to thank you in advance for your precious contribution to the reflection on the sustainable development of these two important value chains in Indonesia!

Yours sincerely,

The Project Management Unit (PMU) of the VCA4D project

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EUROPEAN UNION
DELEGATION TO INDONESIA AND BRUNEI DARUSSALAM

Jakarta, 30 September 2026
Save number: del-indonesia.003.dir(2026)10123361

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

Subject: Value Chain Analysis for Development (VCA4D) studies – value chain analyses on rubber and coconut in Indonesi

The Delegation of the European Union (EU) in Indonesia is pleased to inform that two studies on the value chain of rubber and on the value chain of coconut are launched the framework of the *Value Chain Analysis for Development* (VCA4D) project. VCA4D is funded by the EU and implemented by Agrinatura, the Alliance of European Universities and research centres specialised in agricultural research for development in partner countries.

The assignment is in collaboration with the Ministry of National Development Planning/National Development Planning Agency (Bappenas).

These studies will support an evidence-based assessment of the rubber and coconut sectors. The findings may inform policy making and project development for the promotion of more inclusive, sustainable and deforestation-free agri-food value chains.

The rubber and coconut studies will be performed by a team of seven European and Indonesian experts:

- Mr Eric Penot, economic expert and team leader of the rubber study (based in Europe)
- Mr Ravinder Kumar, social expert of the rubber study (based in Europe)
- Mr Ieben Broeckhoven, environmental expert of the rubber study (based in Europe)
- Mrs Sahara Sahara, economist and team leader of the coconut study (based in Indonesia)
- Mr Augusta Ivanovich, social expert of the coconut study (based in Indonesia)
- Mr Agus Setyarso, environmental expert of the coconut study (based in Indonesia)
- Mrs Heval Yildirim, coordinator and economic expert (based in Europe)

The two teams will work together throughout the assignment from October 2026 to April 2027.
The experts will perform two field missions. The first one is planned from 19th October 2026.

Your support in providing information and data during their visits and throughout the entire period of the assignment will be greatly appreciated. This will allow the studies to be representative of the status of the value chains and to correctly pinpoint the strategic issues that need attention.

The Delegation of the European Union to Indonesia avails the opportunity to thank in advance for your precious collaboration in making the study process successful and to express its highest consideration and best wishes.

Yours sincerely,

Marco Bonetti
Chargé d'Affaires, a.i.

Annex I – Presentation of the VCA4D project

Value Chain Analysis for Development project is an EU funded project that started in 2016 and implemented by Agrinatura. Agrinatura is the grouping of European Universities and Research centres specialised in agricultural research for development with 35 members across Europe. Mobilised at the request of the EU Delegations in partner countries or the European Commission headquarters, the VCA4D project realises value chain analyses to produce evidence-based knowledge about the growth, inclusiveness and sustainability of the VC that the EUD and the partner country's actors can use in the framework of their cooperation.

The VCA4D studies will be realised by applying the EU value chain analysis toolkit, the VCA4D Methodological Framework, as described in the *"VCA4D Methodological Brief for agri-based value chain analysis*". The findings of these studies will allow to appraise and analyse the inclusiveness and sustainability of the value chain from the economic, social and environmental point of view, identifying the most relevant issues requiring policy action, as well as the major risks, bottlenecks and opportunities in the VC development.

Currently in its phase III, VCA4D has or is intervening in more than 40 partner countries with 67 studies concluded, ongoing or in the pipeline, on very different value chains: cereals, fruits and vegetables, fisheries, livestock, cotton, cocoa, coffee, etc.

VCA4D are performed by a team which is made up of an agro economist, a social expert and environmental expert (coming from Agrinatura centres and/or as independents), supported by a national expert with deep knowledge of the sector targeted by the analysis.

The Indonesia VCA4D study process integrates a capacity as well strengthening component. In this case, three national experts, rather than only one, will be trained to the application of the VCA4D methodology by the Agrinatura colleagues and they will perform their own analysis for the coconut value chain.
The final work of the experts, the two VCA4D studies on rubber and coconut, will be shared with all Indonesia value chain actors at the end of the process.

For more information on the project and/or on the specific VCA4D study you can check the VCA4D page or contact the Project Management Unit (PMU) at the VCA4D email address vca4d@agrinatura-eu.eu

Electronically signed on 30/09/2026 04:38 (UTC+02) in accordance with Article 11 of Commission Decision (EU) 2021/2121
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